PHILOSOPHY PAPER II - PHILOSOPHY OF RELIGION 01 - NOTIONS OF GOD

ONE CONTINUOUS AT-A-GLANCE MASTER FLOW | CONCEPTUAL GRAMMAR -> WESTERN MODELS -> ATTRIBUTES -> SPINOZA -> ADVAITA -> RAMANUJA -> INDIAN PARITY -> COMPARISON -> OBJECTIONS -> PYQ ROUTING

Read the cyan rail from Stage 01 to Stage 10. Core doctrine is complete before the PYQ and answer-writing enrichment. Each stage uses a topic-specific visual grammar rather than a repeated card template.

● CYAN: PRIMARY DOCTRINE / CONTINUOUS RAIL | ● AMBER: EXACT TERM / DISTINCTION | ● TEAL: MECHANISM / RELATION | ● RED: OBJECTION / TRAP | ● MAGENTA: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

SOURCE CONTROL CANONICAL OWNERS: Notions-of-God.md + Uncompressed Complete Learning Session + Solved Practice Workbook (all dated/identified in design-spec.json)

APPROVAL: FALSE - NEW G6 GENERATION - USER REVIEW PENDING

CORE FIRST | PYQ ENRICHMENT LAST

01

STAGE 01 CONCEPTUAL GRAMMAR - TWO INDEPENDENT AXES, THEN LANGUAGE CONTROL

PERSONAL != BODILY | IMPERSONAL != INERT | TRANSCENDENT != SPATIALLY FAR | IMMANENT != IDENTICAL | CATAPHATIC = AFFIRM | APOPHATIC = REMOVE LIMITS

2 x 2 AXES - ANALYTICAL PLACEMENTS, NOT COMPLETE DEFINITIONS

PERSONAL + TRANSCENDENT
Classical theism
Intellect, will and love; creator distinct from, yet sustaining, the world.

PERSONAL + IMMANENT
Ramanuja / antaryamin
Supreme person indwells selves and world as controller while exceeding them.

IMPERSONAL + IMMANENT
Spinoza
One infinite substance; finite minds and bodies exist as dependent modes.

IMPERSONAL + TRANSCENDENT
Advaita Nirguna Brahman
Absolute beyond limiting predicates; not a deliberating person among persons.

TWO SPECTRA

PERSONAL — TRANSPERSONAL — IMPERSONAL

Personality axis: agency and relation, not a physical body.

TRANSCENDENT — BOTH — IMMANENT

World-position axis: ontological independence and/or sustaining presence.

CLOSE-OPTION REPAIR
- Personal: intellect, will and purposive relation - never a finite human body.
- Impersonal: not a deliberating person - never inert matter by definition.
- Transcendence: ontological independence - never spatial distance.
- Immanence: presence, sustaining or indwelling - never automatic identity.

CATAPHATIC
Affirms good, wise, powerful and loving. Positive predicates supply religious content.

APOPHATIC
Denies finite, composite and dependent modes of predication: neti neti.

CONTROL RULE
Affirm perfection analogically; deny creaturely limitation. Too much affirmation anthropomorphizes; too much denial empties God-talk.

TRAP A notion of God is a metaphysical profile: referent + attributes + world relation + human relation + religious function. A first cause is not automatically personal, omniscient, good or worship-worthy.

ANSWER LINE **Personal/impersonal describes the mode of ultimacy; transcendent/immanent describes its relation to the world. The axes must never be collapsed.**

BRIDGE NEXT -> WESTERN MODEL FAMILY - FIVE DECISIVE GOD-WORLD-HUMAN RELATIONS

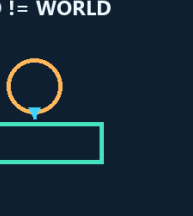
02

STAGE 02 WESTERN MODEL FAMILY - FIVE DECISIVE GOD-WORLD-HUMAN RELATIONS

THEISM = CREATES + SUSTAINS | DEISM = CREATES + WITHDRAWS | PANTHEISM = IDENTITY | PANENTHEISM = WORLD IN GOD | PROCESS = DIPOLAR | RELATION BEFORE LABEL

CLASSICAL THEISM

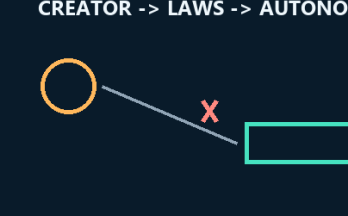
GOD != WORLD



WORLD
Creates ex nihilo and continuously sustains a distinct contingent world.
HUMAN
Personal providence, prayer, moral accountability and creature-Creator relation.
STRENGTH
Personality + transcendence + immanent sustaining activity.
PRESSURE
Evil and coherence of the attribute package.

DEISM

CREATOR -> LAWS -> AUTONOMY



WORLD
An intelligent creator institutes natural laws, then rejects special intervention.
HUMAN
Rational dependence without continuing providence, miracle or revelation.
STRENGTH
Protects natural autonomy and scientific regularity.
PRESSURE
Religiously remote: why worship or pray to a withdrawn designer?

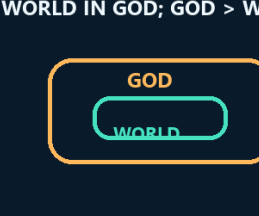
PANTHEISM

GOD = NATURE

WORLD
No external creation; reality exists in the one divine whole.
HUMAN
The person is within divine reality, not a substance outside it.
STRENGTH
Radical unity and immanence.
PRESSURE
May weaken personality, providence, freedom and objective evil.

PANENTHEISM

WORLD IN GOD; GOD > WORLD



WORLD
The world exists in God, but God is not exhausted by the world.
HUMAN
Participation within divine life while genuine divine excess remains.
STRENGTH
Combines immanence with transcendence.
PRESSURE
What exactly does 'in God' mean without spatialization?

PROCESS / DIPOLAR

PRIMORDIAL + CONSEQUENT POLES

WORLD
God orders possibilities and receives the world's becoming; relation is dynamic.
HUMAN
God persuades rather than coercively determines; every event contributes to divine experience.
STRENGTH
Responsiveness and co-suffering without total collapse into the world.
PRESSURE
Revises classical omnipotence, immutability and impassibility.

DECISIVE RELATION TERMS

DISTINCTION / DEPENDENCE | WITHDRAWAL / AUTONOMY | IDENTITY | INCLUSION + EXCESS | MUTUAL BECOMING / PERSUASION

COMPARISON RULE **Always state: definition -> exact God-world formula -> relation to persons -> religious function -> strongest pressure.**

TRAP Pantheism is identity; panentheism is inclusion-with-excess. Deism is not atheism. Classical creation ex nihilo means total ontological dependence, not manufacture from a material called 'nothing'.

ANSWER LINE **Western models differ less by the word 'God' than by whether the world is distinct from, abandoned by, identical with, included in, or dynamically related to the divine.**

BRIDGE NEXT -> DIVINE ATTRIBUTES AND COHERENCE - A PACKAGE, NOT A LIST

03

STAGE 03 DIVINE ATTRIBUTES AND COHERENCE - A PACKAGE, NOT A LIST

OMNIPOTENCE = MAXIMAL COHERENT POWER | OMNISCIENCE = ALL TRUTHS | OMNIBENEVOLENCE = PERFECT GOODNESS | ETERNITY != MERE LONGEVITY | SIMPLICITY != EASY | ASEITY = NON-DEPENDENCE

PERFECT-BEING PACKAGE

OMNIPOTENCE
Power over every logically possible state of affairs consistent with divine nature.

OMNISCIENCE
Knowledge of all truths: past, present, future and, classically, counterfactuals.

OMNIBENEVOLENCE
Perfect goodness: God cannot will evil as evil; permission requires justification.

ETERNITY
Timeless nunc stans or everlasting duration; stronger than merely very old.

IMMUTABILITY
Essential divine nature does not change; relational differences require explanation.

SIMPLICITY
No composition; attributes are not detachable properties added to a divine subject.

ASEITY
Exists from itself in the sense of deriving from nothing else; not self-caused.

TENSION	PHILOSOPHICAL PROBLEM	STRONGEST REPLY	RESIDUAL / TRAP
POWER vs LOGIC	Can God make a square circle or a stone an omnipotent being cannot lift?	Contradictions specify no genuine task; omnipotence covers the absolutely possible.	TRAP: 'Cannot do contradictions' is not a finite defect.
FOREKNOWLEDGE vs FREEDOM	If God infallibly knows S chooses A, can S choose not-A?	Knowledge need not cause the act; timelessness, soft facts, Molinism or open theism target different premises.	TRAP: non-causation alone does not reopen alternative possibilities.
GOODNESS vs EVIL	Why permit preventable suffering if God knows and can prevent it?	Free-will defence, soul-making and greater-good replies explain permission, not denial of evil.	Natural and excessive evil remain pressure points.
IMMUTABILITY vs LOVE	Can an unchanging, impassible God respond or co-suffer?	Constancy of active love need not mean emotional inertness.	Reciprocity and responsive agency remain difficult.
SIMPLICITY vs MANY ATTRIBUTES	How can one simple reality be power, knowledge and goodness?	Predicates differ in our concepts but signify one divine reality.	Modal collapse and property-identity objections remain.

1. God infallibly knows at t1 that S does A at t2.
2. The past and infallibility appear fixed.
3. Therefore S cannot do otherwise at t2.
4. A compatibilist denies that alternative possibilities are required; a libertarian must deny or revise a premise.

TRAP Freedom and omnipotence are not direct contradictories. Distinguish possessing power from constantly exercising exhaustive control, then state which foreknowledge premise your solution rejects.

ANSWER LINE **The God-concept is a package of mutually constrained perfections; coherence is earned only after power, knowledge, goodness, time, change and simplicity are specified.**

BRIDGE NEXT -> SPINOZA - DEUS SIVE NATURA INSIDE THE METAPHYSICS OF SUBSTANCE

04

STAGE 04 SPINOZA - DEUS SIVE NATURA INSIDE THE METAPHYSICS OF SUBSTANCE

DEUS SIVE NATURA | ONE INFINITE SUBSTANCE | IN ITSELF / CONCEIVED THROUGH ITSELF | INFINITE ATTRIBUTES | THOUGHT + EXTENSION | FINITE MODES | IMPERSONAL IMMANENCE | NECESSITY

GOD OR NATURE - ONE INFINITE SUBSTANCE
self-caused (causa sui); ontologically and conceptually independent

ATTRIBUTE: THOUGHT
The intellect perceives the essence of substance as thinking reality.
FINITE MODES: ideas and minds

ATTRIBUTE: EXTENSION
The intellect perceives the same essence as extended reality.
FINITE MODES: bodies and motions

SUBSTANCE TREE RULE God has infinitely many attributes; humans know Thought and Extension. Attributes are not separable parts and modes are not independent substances.

NATURA NATURANS
Nature naturing: God/Nature as active, infinite, self-caused substance.

NECESSARY EXPRESSION
No free first decision to create; the modal order follows eternally from divine nature.

NATURA NATURATA
Nature natured: the complete dependent order of modes.

OBJECTION: PERSONALITY
No deliberating will, providence, command or reciprocal prayer.
REPLY: person-like will would finitely anthropomorphize the infinite.

OBJECTION: FREEDOM
Necessity seems to destroy alternative choice.
REPLY: freedom is action from one's own nature without external constraint.

OBJECTION: PANTHEISTIC COLLAPSE
Calling each finite object 'God' confuses a mode with the whole substance.
REPLY: finite things are in God as dependent modes; God is not their aggregate.

TRAP Spinoza's Nature is not merely physical matter. Deus sive Natura states identity, while the substance-attribute-mode architecture explains that identity.

ANSWER LINE **Spinoza replaces the transcendent personal creator with an impersonal, immanent and necessary infinite substance whose attributes are expressed through finite modes.**

BRIDGE NEXT -> ADVAITA - ONE BRAHMAN, TWO STANDPOINTS, THREE LEVELS OF REALITY

05

STAGE 05 ADVAITA - ONE BRAHMAN, TWO STANDPOINTS, THREE LEVELS OF REALITY

NIRGUNA BRAHMAN | SAGUNA ISVARA | SAT-CIT-ANANDA | MAYA + ADHYASA | VIVARTA != PARINAMA | ATMAN = BRAHMAN | ANIRVACANIYA: MAYA, NOT BRAHMAN

PARAMARTHIKA - ABSOLUTE
NIRGUNA BRAHMAN
- Non-dual reality beyond limiting and relational predicates.
- Sat-cit-ananda: being, consciousness and fullness - not three detachable qualities.
- Neti neti removes object-like limitations; Brahman is not a blank non-being.
- Atman-Brahman identity: liberation recognizes an always-existing identity.

VYAVAHARIKA - EMPIRICAL
SAGUNA ISVARA
- Brahman understood in relation to maya as omniscient creator, sustainer and dissolver.
- Valid object of devotion, meditation and moral governance wherever plurality is experienced.
- Niguna-Isvara distinction is religiously real at this level but ultimately sublated.
- Same Brahman, not a second deity or rival ultimate.

ONE REALITY Same Brahman under two epistemic standpoints - not two independent Brahmans.

THREE LEVELS OF REALITY

PARAMARTHIKA
Brahman alone is absolutely real.

VYAVAHARIKA
Shared world, causation, jiva and Isvara.

PRATIBHASIKA
Dream, hallucination and rope-snake error.

MAYA / ADHYASA / VIVARTA FLOW

ROPE + IGNORANCE -> SNAKE APPEARANCE -> FEAR

KNOWLEDGE -> APPEARANCE SUBLATED -> ROPE RECOGNIZED

BRAHMAN + AVIDYA -> PLURAL WORLD -> BONDAGE

JNANA -> DIFFERENCE SUBLATED -> BRAHMAN RECOGNIZED

TECHNICAL CORRECTION **TECHNICAL PRECISION: anirvacaniya (neither absolutely real nor absolutely unreal) applies to maya/avidya and the world-appearance. Do not call Brahman anirvacaniya. Brahman's ineffability concerns failed limiting predication: avacya / neti neti.**

OBJECTION: Nirguna is an empty abstraction. REPLY: apophasis removes finite limits, not reality.

OBJECTION: if Brahman alone exists, who is ignorant? REPLY: ignorance belongs to the empirical jiva; its locus remains contested.

VERDICT ON THEISM: Advaita preserves religion at the path level but transcends creator-creature duality at the goal level.

TRAP Mithya is dependent and sublatable, not sheer nothing. Maya explains apparent plurality without a real transformation of Brahman; vivarta must not be confused with parinama.

ANSWER LINE **Advaita reconciles personal religion and impersonal ultimacy by validating Saguna Isvara empirically while locating final reality in Nirguna Brahman and Atman-Brahman identity.**

BRIDGE NEXT -> VISISTADVAITA / RAMANUJA - ORGANIC UNITY OF GOD, SELVES AND WORLD

06

STAGE 06 VISISTADVAITA / RAMANUJA - ORGANIC UNITY OF GOD, SELVES AND WORLD

PERSONAL SAGUNA BRAHMAN | CIT + ACIT = GOD'S BODY | SARIRA-SARIRI | APRTHAK-SIDDHI | MATERIAL + EFFICIENT CAUSE | PARINAMA / REAL MANIFESTATION | BHAKTI + PRAPATTI

BRAHMAN / NARAYANA - SUPREME PERSONAL SAGUNA REALITY

SARIRI - INDWELLING SELF, CONTROLLER AND PURPOSE

CIT - CONSCIOUS SELVES
Real, many, morally responsible and eternally dependent jivas.

ACIT - NON-CONSCIOUS MATTER
Real, changing material order governed from within by God.

SARIRA-SARIRI A body is controlled by, exists for, and is completely dependent upon its indwelling self. Therefore the cosmos is God's body without being a giant anthropomorphic organism.

CAUSE CYCLE

SUBTLE CIT-ACIT IN BRAHMAN
causal state

REAL MANIFESTATION / PARINAMA
dependent material principle changes

GROSS WORLD + EMBODIED JIVAS
effect state

DISSOLUTION
returns to subtle dependence

APRTHAK-SIDDHI + CAUSATION

JIVA != BRAHMAN

JIVA CANNOT EXIST INDEPENDENTLY OF BRAHMAN

APRTHAK-SIDDHI = DISTINCTION + DEPENDENCE + INSEPARABILITY

LIBERATION PRESERVES INDIVIDUALITY IN COMMUNION AND SERVICE

- Efficient cause: divine intelligence directs manifestation.
- Material cause: acit is inseparable from Brahman as divine body.
- God's essential perfection does not turn into defective matter; change is in dependent modes.

DEVOTION / GRACE PATH

KNOWLEDGE + DISCIPLINED ACTION

BHAKTI - SUSTAINED LOVING CONTEMPLATION

PRAPATTI - COMPLETE SURRENDER TO GRACE

LIBERATION - COMMUNION AND SERVICE, NOT LOSS OF SELF

OBJECTION: If the world is God's body, do suffering and moral evil contaminate God?

REPLY: defect belongs to the changing controlled body, not the essential perfection of the controller.

RESIDUAL PRESSURE: complete divine control still raises responsibility for the condition of the body.

TRAP Aprthak-siddhi is not identity. The body metaphor expresses metaphysical control and dependence, not finite physical embodiment. Ramanuja's world is real, not Advaitic mithya.

ANSWER LINE **Ramanuja secures unity without erasing plurality: cit and acit are the real body of personal Brahman, distinct yet inseparable through sarira-sariri and aprthak-siddhi.**

BRIDGE NEXT -> INDIAN PARITY BENCH - NYAYA CAUSATION + HINDU DIVINE PLURALITY

07

STAGE 07 INDIAN PARITY BENCH - NYAYA CAUSATION + HINDU DIVINE PLURALITY

NYAYA = PLURALIST REALISM | ISVARA = SPECIAL SELF | GOD EFFICIENT; ATOMS MATERIAL | ADRISTA + MORAL GOVERNANCE | POLYTHEISM != HENOTHEISM | KATHENOTHEISM = ONE-AT-A-TIME | MONISM != MONOTHEISM

NYAYA: GOD ORDERS; GOD DOES NOT BECOME MATTER

ISVARA - EFFICIENT CAUSE
- Eternal, omniscient and omnipotent special self never bound by karma.
- Nimitta-karana: intelligent efficient cause of cosmic order.
- Initiates atomic combination, sustains order, governs dissolution and later authors the Veda.

ETERNAL REALITIES - MATERIAL SIDE
- Eternal atoms are the material causes; selves, space and time are also real.
- Nyaya rejects creation ex nihilo and rejects transformation of God into the world.
- The cosmos is ordered by God; it is not a mode, appearance or body of God.

KARMA CIRCUIT **HUMAN ACT -> MERIT / DEMERIT (ADRISTA) -> ISVARA INTELLIGENTLY COORDINATES CONSEQUENCES -> APPROPRIATE PLEASURE / PAIN -> Purusakara (human effort) is preserved against fatalistic daiva.**

NYAYA OBJECTION / REPLY
OBJECTION: Karma makes God redundant. REPLY: unconscious adrista and inert atoms cannot intelligently administer their own ordered distribution. Residual question: does administration require an infinite God?

ANSWER ROUTE **Pluralist realism -> Isvara as special self -> efficient cause -> eternal atoms as material cause -> adrista administration -> one objection.**

Do not answer the nature question by merely listing proofs such as karyat and ayojanat.

HINDU DIVINE PLURALITY - TAXONOMY LADDER

POLYTHEISM
Many genuinely divine beings with distinct agencies; asks whether there are plural ultimates.

HENOTHEISM
Several gods acknowledged while one is worshipped as supreme in a context.

KATHENOTHEISM
Different deities are addressed as supreme successively - 'one god at a time'.

SECTARIAN MONOTHEISM
Vaisnava, Saiva or Sakta devotion treats one supreme deity and subordinates other forms.

UPANISADIC MONISM
One ultimate reality; unity of reality is not automatically one personal God.

VEDIC ANCHOR **RV 1.164.46 - 'ekam sad vipra bahudha vadanti': the one existent is spoken of in many ways. Use it as evidence for plural names/forms, not as an automatic proof that every Hindu school is monotheistic or monistic.**

QUALIFIED VERDICT **QUALIFIED VERDICT: Hinduism is not adequately described by one label. Polytheistic practice, henotheistic/kathenotheistic invocation, sectarian monotheism and Upanisadic monism coexist. State the tradition, level and criterion of ultimacy.**

TRAP A 'nature of Nyaya God' answer must prioritize attributes, efficient causation, eternal atoms, karma and moral governance - not merely list Udayana's proofs.

ANSWER LINE **Indian parity prevents false homogenization: Nyaya preserves an efficient divine governor beside eternal atoms, while Hindu plurality ranges from many worshipped forms to one ultimate reality.**

BRIDGE NEXT -> COMPARATIVE GOD-WORLD-HUMAN RELATION MATRIX - SIX NON-EQUIVALENT GRAMMARS

08

STAGE 08 COMPARATIVE GOD-WORLD-HUMAN RELATION MATRIX - SIX NON-EQUIVALENT GRAMMARS

CREATION != IDENTITY | IDENTITY != EMBODIMENT | EMBODIMENT != APPEARANCE | APPEARANCE != ATOMIC ORDERING | SAME AXES FOR EVERY MODEL | NATURE + WORLD + HUMAN + CAUSE

CLASSICAL THEISM
CREATION / TOTAL DEPENDENCE

DEISM
CREATION + WITHDRAWAL

SPINOZA
IDENTITY / MODE-SUBSTANCE

ADVAITA
DEPENDENT APPEARANCE / IDENTITY

RAMANUJA
BODY-SOUL / INSEPARABILITY

NYAYA
EFFICIENT ARRANGEMENT / MATERIAL ATOMS

MODEL	DIVINE NATURE	GOD-WORLD	GOD-HUMAN	CAUSATION	RELIGIOUS FUNCTION / PRESSURE
CLASSICAL THEISM	Personal, necessary, omni-perfect, transcendent and immanently sustaining.	World is distinct, contingent and continuously dependent.	Creature-Creator relation; providence, prayer and moral accountability.	Creation ex nihilo; primary cause sustains secondary causes.	Strong relational worship; pressure from evil and attribute coherence.
DEISM	Personal intelligent designer, usually remote after creation.	Creates law-governed world, then rejects special intervention.	Rational dependence without continuing providence.	First institution of laws; natural order thereafter autonomous.	Fits natural regularity; weakens miracle, revelation and prayer.
SPINOZA	Impersonal, infinite, necessary substance: Deus sive Natura.	Finite things are modes in God/Nature; no external creation.	Mind and body are finite modes under Thought and Extension.	Necessary expression, not free production.	Intellectual love and rational freedom; loses personal reciprocity.
ADVAITA	Nirguna Brahman ultimately; Saguna Isvara empirically.	World is mithya through vivarta; Isvara governs empirical order.	Atman is Brahman; jiva-Isvara distinction is provisional.	Apparent manifestation without real change in Brahman.	Devotion prepares for knowledge; final theism is transcended.
RAMANUJA	Supreme personal saguna Brahman qualified by real cit and acit.	World and selves are God's real body; God indwells and exceeds them.	Jiva is distinct, dependent and inseparable; liberation preserves service.	Material and efficient cause; real manifestation / parinama.	Bhakti, prapatti and grace; pressure from evil in the divine body.
NYAYA	Personal omniscient special self within pluralist realism.	God orders eternal atoms and administers a real moral cosmos.	Distinct eternal selves receive karmic fruits through divine governance.	God efficient cause; atoms material causes.	Moral administration and Vedic authorship; karma may seem sufficient.

PHYSICAL CAUSE TEST **PHYSICAL MANIFESTATION TEST: classical theism, Advaita and Nyaya deny that an ultimate cause must be a physical object. Ramanuja's 'body' is technical dependence/control, not a finite anthropomorphic form. A cause may be known through effects without resembling them.**

ULTIMATE REALITY TEST
Perfect personal agency (theism/deism/Ramanuja/Nyaya) versus impersonal infinite substance or non-dual consciousness (Spinoza/Advaita).

WORLD STATUS TEST
Distinct dependent creation | autonomous law-order | mode in substance | mithya appearance | divine body | ordered eternal atoms.

HUMAN STATUS TEST
Creature | rational dependent | finite mode | Atman-Brahman identity | distinct-inseparable jiva | karmic eternal self.

RELIGIOUS FUNCTION TEST
Providence and prayer | remoteness | intellectual love | liberating knowledge | bhakti/prapatti | moral governance.

TRAP Never equate Spinoza's modes, Advaita's appearance, Ramanuja's body and Nyaya's ordered atoms. They are identity, sublation, embodiment and causal distinction respectively.

ANSWER LINE **Comparison is philosophically valid only when every model is tested through the same axes: divine nature, world status, human status, causation and religious function.**

BRIDGE NEXT -> OBJECTIONS, STRONGEST REPLIES AND EXAMINER TRAPS

09

STAGE 09 OBJECTIONS, STRONGEST REPLIES AND EXAMINER TRAPS

STATE THE TARGET PREMISE | LOGICAL POSSIBILITY TRAP | REPLY AT THE SAME LEVEL | KEEP THE RESIDUAL COST | KNOWLEDGE != CAUSATION | BODY != PHYSICAL FORM | MITHYA != NON-BEING | MODE != WHOLE SUBSTANCE

OMNIPOTENCE / LOGIC
OBJECTION
If God cannot actualize contradictions, something lies beyond divine power.
STRONGEST REPLY
A contradiction does not name a possible object of power; maximal power ranges over genuine possibilities.
RESIDUAL COST
Descartes-style universal possibilism is an outlier that makes logic dependent on will.

FOREKNOWLEDGE / FREEDOM
OBJECTION
Infallible knowledge of A seems to close the possibility of not-A.
STRONGEST REPLY
Knowledge is not causation; timelessness, Ockhamism, Molinism and open theism deny different premises.
RESIDUAL COST
Do not claim the problem is solved until alternative possibilities or compatibilist freedom are specified.

SPINOZA / PERSONALITY
OBJECTION
An impersonal necessary whole cannot command, forgive, answer prayer or choose creation.
STRONGEST REPLY
Personality would impose finite human categories; divine freedom is absence of external constraint.
RESIDUAL COST
Metaphysical ultimacy is retained, but worshipful reciprocity is weakened.

ADVAITA / INTELLIGIBILITY
OBJECTION
Nirguna Brahman is empty, and maya's locus is unexplained.
STRONGEST REPLY
Apophatic negation removes limiting predicates; empirical jiva is the locus of ignorance.
RESIDUAL COST
Positive intelligibility and the locus/power of avidya remain contested.

RAMANUJA / DIVINE DEFECT
OBJECTION
If the suffering world is God's body, evil appears to infect God.
STRONGEST REPLY
The condition of a dependent body does not transfer every defect to the controlling self.
RESIDUAL COST
Complete control still leaves a responsibility problem.

NYAYA / REDUNDANCY
OBJECTION
If karma fixes desert and atoms supply matter, God adds no explanation.
STRONGEST REPLY
Unconscious adrista and inert atoms need intelligent ordering and distribution.
RESIDUAL COST
The move from administration to an infinite omniscient self remains debatable.

ARGUMENT FOR MANIFESTATION
FOR: familiar causes are encountered through effects or embodied action; an utterly unmanifest cause may seem empirically idle.

ARGUMENT AGAINST NECESSITY
AGAINST: a physical form is spatially limited, divisible and dependent. Ultimate causality requires explanatory non-dependence, not bodily manifestation.

GRADED VERDICT
VERDICT: embodiment may aid religious access, but it is not conceptually necessary for every ultimate cause.

TEN EXAMINER TRAPS - READ ACROSS

1. Personal does not mean anthropomorphic.
2. Transcendent does not mean spatially remote.
3. Immanent does not mean pantheistically identical.
4. Saguna and Nirguna are not two independent Brahmans.
5. Anirvacaniya technically applies to maya/world appearance, not Brahman.
6. Aprthak-siddhi is inseparability, not numerical identity.
7. Nyaya God is not the material cause.
8. Monism is not automatically monotheism.
9. Process dipolarity revises classical immutability and omnipotence.
10. A graded verdict must preserve the cost of the reply.

TRAP The examiner rewards dialectic: doctrine -> target objection -> strongest reply -> residual cost. A reply that merely repeats the doctrine earns little.

ANSWER LINE **No model escapes cost: each protects one dimension of ultimacy by revising another, so the best conclusion is comparative and graded rather than triumphalist.**

BRIDGE NEXT -> PYQ ROUTING, ANSWER SPINES AND MODEL PHILOSOPHICAL CONCLUSION

10

STAGE 10 PYQ ROUTING, ANSWER SPINES AND MODEL PHILOSOPHICAL CONCLUSION

13 VERIFIED OWNER PYQS: 2018-2024 | DEFINE BEFORE EVALUATING | CONSTANT COMPARISON AXES | OBJECTION -> REPLY -> RESIDUAL | 10 / 15 / 20 MARK SPINES | DIRECTIVE FIDELITY | GRADED VERDICT

YEAR / MARKS	VERIFIED ASK	NON-NEGOTIABLE ROUTE
2018 - 10	Is Hinduism poly-theistic?	Criterion of plurality -> polytheism / henotheism / kathenotheism -> RV 1.164.46 -> qualified verdict.
2019 - 15	Personalistic and impersonalistic aspects of God.	Define axes -> classical theism / Spinoza -> Saguna / Nirguna -> strengths, pressures and synthesis.
2019 - 15	Man-God relation in any one religion in India.	Choose one complete system -> nature -> world -> self -> bondage/liberation -> critical assessment.
2020 - 10	Freedom of will and an omnipotent God.	Define power/freedom -> self-restraint -> foreknowledge premises -> named solution -> cost.
2020 - 20	Nature of God in Hinduism with special reference to Visistadvaita.	Personal Brahman -> cit-acit body -> aprthak-siddhi -> causation -> bhakti/prapatti -> defect objection.
2021 - 10	Nature of God in Nyaya philosophy.	Pluralist realism -> special self -> efficient cause / material atoms -> adrista -> objection/reply.
2022 - 10	Spinoza's notion of God and His attributes.	Deus sive Natura -> one substance -> attributes/modes -> necessity -> personality objection.
2022 - 15	Relation between God and Self according to Ramanuja.	Sarira-sariri -> aprthak-siddhi -> difference + dependence -> liberation preserves individuality.
2022 - 15	Sankara's Brahman and whether it leaves room for theism.	Nirguna / Saguna -> sat-cit-ananda -> maya/vivarta -> two levels -> provisional theism verdict.
2023 - 10	Elucidate personalistic and impersonalistic aspects.	Clarify contrast -> Western and Indian pairs -> reconciliation device -> exact concluding distinction.
2023 - 15	How is God both immanent and transcendent in theism?	Ontological definitions -> classical sustaining cause -> Ramanuja contrast -> one-sided dangers.
2024 - 15	Spinoza's God embedded in substance and attributes.	Substance argument -> Thought/Extension -> modes -> Natura naturans/naturata -> critical verdict.
2024 - 15	Must ultimate cause have physical manifestation?	Distinguish embodiment / manifestation / causation -> strongest for and against -> comparative verdict.

10 MARKS
Define exact contrast -> 2 doctrines -> one discriminating relation -> one objection/reply -> direct verdict.

15 MARKS
Frame problem -> reconstruct doctrine/presupposition -> canonical example -> nearest rival -> objection/reply -> graded verdict.

20 MARKS
Classify God-concept -> full metaphysics -> world + human relations -> Indian-Western comparison -> two dialectics -> surviving notion of ultimacy.

ELUCIDATE
clarify a distinction precisely

DISCUSS
balanced exposition plus stated position

CRITICALLY EXAMINE
reconstruct, object, reply and assess

DO YOU AGREE?
announce criterion, test both sides, decide

MODEL PHILOSOPHICAL CONCLUSION **MODEL CONCLUSION: The notion of God is not one universal concept but a family of metaphysical models. Classical theism preserves perfect agency and transcendence; Spinoza secures unity and necessity; Advaita protects non-dual absoluteness; Ramanuja reconciles unity with real plurality; and Nyaya preserves intelligent causation and moral governance. Their adequacy depends on whether ultimacy is understood primarily as perfect agency, infinite substance, non-dual consciousness, organic unity or intelligent ordering.**

TRAP Do not write a generic theology essay. Name the model, state its God-world-human grammar, use the exact technical relation, test one objection, and answer the printed directive.

ANSWER LINE **A high-scoring answer moves from definition to metaphysical mechanism, then to relation, objection, reply and a qualified comparative verdict.**

BRIDGE END OF MASTER -> Use Stage 10 to route the exact printed demand.